



THUNDERBOLT
Global Logistics, LLC

Ms. Rachel E. Dickon, Assistant Secretary
800 North Capitol Street N.W. Suite 1046
Washington, DC 20573-0001

July 3, 2017

**BEFORE THE
FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION**

DOCKET NO. 17-04

REGULATORY REFORM INITIATIVE

I am James S. Shapiro, co-owner of Thunderbolt Global Logistics, LLC based in Baltimore, MD. We are an International Freight Forwarder/NVOCC operating under OTI License number 021287NF. We only have the one office in Baltimore.

Our company has taken full advantage of using Negotiated Rate Arrangements (NRA's) and we are grateful that the Commission approved this exemption to tariff filing. It has saved us significant annual savings in tariff filing expenses. Our staff can serve our customers without having to stop and file a rate. We have converted nearly all of our rate offerings to NRA's for our clients and some of our overseas partners.

We would like to see more flexibility with what can be covered in an NRA. We feel it's important to be able to amend them when the market conditions change. We would like to be able to include credit terms and service standards in the NRA.

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We would like to see the requirement to have a tariff and file rates be eliminated altogether.

We must maintain a tariff to comply with the FMC's NVOCC regulations. We have to pay \$200.00 per month to publish our tariff. For a small company like ours \$2400.00 per year is a considerable expense. We don't see a need for tariff filing at all.

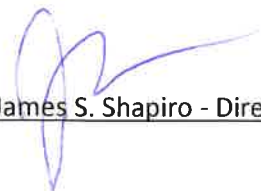
If we have a shipment that is received in Chicago but sails out of a Canadian port we don't need to file any rates. If the same shipment sailed from Norfolk, VA we would have to file a rate or have an NRA in place. I really don't see a need at all to have to maintain a tariff and file rates. Air freight rates are not filed with any government body and there hasn't been any harm done in the marketplace. Eliminating tariff filing altogether and the need for a tariff will save our industry considerable money.

We also feel that the co-loading regulations in section 520.11 should be simplified in order to eliminate unnecessary regulatory requirements that serve only as a basis for being penalized (such as the requirement that the tendering NVOCC annotate its house bill of lading with the name of the master loader). This isn't really necessary. It's another market force that enables a shipper and NVOCC to obtain favorable rates.

Please consider these comments as you look to reduce the regulatory burden on our industry.

Thank you in advance.

DATED: July 3, 2017


James S. Shapiro - Director

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